

\$10
million
the total value of
customized sweets
sold by Mars by
2007, including
coloured M&M's

FOUR TYPES OF MASS CUSTOMIZATION

In his book *Mass Customization: The New Frontier in Business Competition*, B. Joseph Pine II outlines four distinct types:

› Collaborative customization

Work with individual customer to develop specific product to suit their needs. Technology firm Dell, for example, assembles computers to customer's specification.

› Adaptive customization

Produce standardized products that are customizable by end-user. For instance, US company Lutron produces a lighting system that lets customers choose own setting from programmed settings.

› Transparent customization

Provide unique products to individuals without overtly stating items are customized: the Ritz-Carlton hotel group keeps a database of preferences for pillows and newspapers to personalize a guest's stay.

› **Cosmetic customization** Make a standardized product but market it differently: Hertz distinguishes its standard rental car from its #1 Club Gold program.

